The Bruce Herald.

TAIERI, WAIHOLA, CLUTHA, GOLDFIELDS, AND SOUTHERN DISTRICTS RECORDER.

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HOTELS, &c.

OFFICIAL.

Some calabastic tongues have power
To bind one's foes in fetters;
No wonder there's a charm in words
When there's a spell in letters.

No I's are there in human eyes,
But E's there are in ease;
And in hub-bub-bub-beb-erous
The B's are thick as bees.

THE season is now in the sear and yellow leaf. When winter draws nigh, you can call in and warm yourselves by my Kaitangata, ah, ah! You can get Mulled Ale with Gingab, ah, ah! Elderberry Wine with Spice, ah, ah! If a Good Templar, ah, ah, you can get a glass of spring watab, ah, ah, ah, with a Gooseberry in it, ah, ah, ah!

Your truly, ta ta,

F. BASTINGS,
White Horse Hotel, Milton.

N.B.—Lessons in the art of Ventriloquism and smashing Blue Bottles 20 guineas per quarter. Office through the skylight No. 16.—F.B.

ROYAL HOTEL, MILTON.

THE Undersigned having purchased from Mr Thomas Stanbrook, the Goodwill and Lease of the above Commodious Hotel, situated close to the Milton Railway Station, begs to solicit a continuance of the kind patronage so liberally bestowed on his predecessor.

No trouble will be spared to make all guests heartily welcome and comfortable, and none but first-class and unadulterated liquors will be kept on hand.

FIRST-CLASS STABLES ON THE PREMISES.

MICHAEL KETT,
Proprietor.

Milton, April 3, 1880.

GLASGOW PIE HOUSE & HOTEL

CORNER OF
PRINCES AND DOWLING STREETS,
DUNEDIN.

John Donaldson - - - Proprietor.

THIS Hotel, from its central position, being near the Railway Station and Post-office, will be found a desirable residence for persons from all parts of the country.

A splendid Billiard Room, with one of Alcock's prize tables.

Wines and Spirits of the very best brands.

Delicious Veal and Mutton Pies.

Sandwiches, or Pastry, with beer, coffee, or porter, 6d.

Hot Suppers consisting of Grills, Poached eggs, Tripe, Welsh Rabbits, &c., with beer, coffee, or porter, 1s.

ORIENTAL HOTEL,

PRINCES-STREET, DUNEDIN.

THOMAS STANBROOK ... ... Proprietor
(Late of Balclutha and Milton).

T. S. respectfully intimates that having just returned from England, he has leased the above Hotel, where he will be happy to meet his old friends and patrons.

The Bedroom and Cuisine Departments will be under the able superintendence of Mrs S., whose capabilities are well known to the Travelling Public.

The Landlord always at home, and intending visitors to the Old Country can be advised as to the best and most economical route, with all information given as to travelling both by sea and rail.

All Ales, Wines, and Spirits of the best brands.

ORIENTAL HOTEL,
PRINCES-STREET, DUNEDIN.

THOMAN STANBROOK ... ... Proprietor.

PAINLESS DENTISTRY.

MR HORACE ROBINSON,
SURGEON DENTIST,
(LATE ROBINSON AND RAYMOND.)

Address: Corner of Moray Place and George-street, Dunedin (over Johnson's Drapery Establishment).

Mr Horace Robinson's long experience in the Profession, together with all the improvements in the mechanical department, will ensure to his patients every satisfaction and comfort.

NO CHARGE FOR ADVICE.

SCALE OF CHARGES:

Extractions	£0	2	6
Stopping Teeth	0	7	6
Artificial Teeth	0	15	0
Single Sets	8	0	0
Double Sets	15	0	0

HOTELS, &c.

BLACK HORSE BREWERY, MILTON.

J. T. KOFOED ... ... PROPRIETOR
(Late Kofoed and Clive).

J. T. K. has much pleasure in intimating to the inhabitants of Tokomairiro and surrounding Districts, that he has purchased the interest of his late Partner, Mr STEPHEN CLIVE, and will in future carry on the Business on his own account.

All orders or letters sent to the brewery will receive immediate attention.

Notice to Customers: Please to cork barrels when empty.

Yeast and Grains always on sale.

This BREWERY commands an abundant supply of Spring Water, free from decomposed vegetable or organic matter, therefore Consumers can depend upon the ALES AND PORTER manufactured at this Establishment being of a SOUND, WHOLESOME, AND INVIGORATING CHARACTER.

Agent for
Feraud's Tonic Bitter Wines and Cordials.

MATTHEW HENDERSON,

PROVISION AND GRAIN MERCHANT,
WAIHOLA GORGE,

HAS ON SALE,—

Woolpacks
Sheepshears
(Burgon and Ball, and Ward and Payne)
Boiled Oil
Lamp Black, and
Ruddle.

Swede, Aberdeen Yellow, and Purple-top Turnip Seed.

MALDEN ISLAND GUANO.

BONE DUST.

ALSO,—
DRAPERY, CLOTHING, BOOTS, &c., at greatly reduced prices.

MATTHEW HENDERSON,
MILBURN STORE.

Agent for the Union Insurance Company of New Zealand.

JOHN WATERS,

VETERINARY SURGEON,
LIVERY AND BAIT STABLES,
Union street, Milton.

NOTICE TO STOCK OWNERS.

I BEG to announce to Farmers, Stock Owners, and others, that I am prepared to Castrate Colts from one month old, and treat for rupture or any diseases to which animals are subject.

JOHN WATERS,
Veterinary Surgeon, Milton.

IMPORTANT TO ALL!!!

R. JOHNSTON,
TAILOR & CLOTHIER,
174, GEORGE-STREET, DUNEDIN

R. J. invites the attention of the public to his New Stock of

SPRING GOODS,

Viz., West of England Broadcloths, English, Scotch, and Mosgiel Tweeds Diagonal Cloths, &c.,
At the lowest possible prices in the city.
Come and judge for yourselves.

FOR SALE.

FOR SALE, a 20-h.p. HORIZONTAL ENGINE—a very substantial article. Will be disposed of on Reasonable Terms, as money must be raised.

A. M'DONALD,
Engineer, Milton.

BUSINESS NOTICES.

R. R. JONES,

COUNCIL CHAMBES, MILTON.

LAND BROKER, COMMISSION AND FINANCIAL AGENT.

LOANS NEGOTIATED.

GENERAL AGENCY UNDERTAKEN.

AGENT FOR—

VICTORIA INSURANCE COMPANY
STANDARD INSURANCE COMPANY
NATIONAL INSURANCE COMPANY

Insurances effected on houses, farm buildings, threshing mills, stacks and live stock, at current rates.

NOTICE.

TO THE PUBLIC OF MILTON AND SURROUNDING DISTRICTS.

ANDREW M'LAREN
BUTCHER,
MAIN SOUTH ROAD, MILTON.

Families waited on daily for Orders.

Cattle, Horses, &c., bought and sold.

TRY the following well known Medicines:

PETTIT'S ANTI-BILIOUS PILLS.
PETTIT'S TOOTHACHE TINCTURE.
PETTIT'S CONDITION POWDERS FOR HORSES.
PETTIT'S CHILBLAIN LINIMENT.

Prepared only by
J. D. WALKER
(Late E. PETTIT,)
Chemist, Tokomairiro.

COOKING RANGES.

BARNINGHAM & CO., Manufactures of the

PATENT PRIZE RANGE ZEALANDIA,

requires no setting, and will burn any coal, and can be used as an Open Fireplace.

Iron Fretwork for Verandahs in great variety.

VICTORIA FOUNDRY,
King-street (opposite Hospital), Dunedin.

NOTICE.

PETER FARRELL,
(late Clerk to Bench),

BEGS to announce to his friends and the public of Tokomairiro that he has commenced business as

ACCOUNTANT, COMMISSION AND HOUSE AGENT,

and solicits a share of their patronage.

OFFICE:—Adjoining Mr G. White's, hairdress, Union-street, Milton.

THE COLONIAL INVESTMENT AND AGENCY COMPANY OF NEW ZEALAND (LIMITED).

CAPITAL - - - - £500,000.

Head Office ... ... Edinburgh.
Head Colonial Office ... ... Dunedin.

Money advanced on approved securities at current rates of interest.

T. T. RITCHIE,
Colonial Manager.

OFFICE:
Colonial Bank Buildings, Water-street, DUNEDIN.

RITCHIE, BARTLEMAN AND CO.

BEG to intimate that they are prepared to undertake all Agency business on avourable terms; and in particular—

The purchase or sale of land.

The buying or disposing of shares in any Public Company.

The investing and borrowing of money.

Agents for Otago for the Northern Assurance Company of London and Aberdeen.

Offices—COLONIAL BANK BUILDINGS,
Water-street, Dunedin.
Dunedin, March 1, 1883.

TO BUILDERS, CONTRACTORS, &c., &c., &c.

WE are prepared to execute WITH DESPATCH orders for Rough and Dressed Timbers in any quantities.

RED, WHITE, AND BLACK PINE, AND TOTARA.

New and Improved Dressing Machinery in use.

MOORE AND SHAND,
SAWMILLERS & TIMBER MERCHANTS,
Steam Saw and Planing Mills, Mabel Bush.

Timber Yards, Siding, and Office—Woodlands.
Address—Woodlands.

NEW ADVERTISEMENT

BROWN, EWING, & CO.

HAVE the pleasure to notify that they have succeeded in effecting the purchase from the Directors of the

OAMARU

WOOLLEN FACTORY,

at a Discount of One-third off Manufactured Cost, the

ENTIRE STOCK

OF

LADIES' DRESS TWEEDS

The Stock consists of

ABOUT 5800 YARDS

of perfectly NEW GOODS, all splendid colourings, shades, and designs, and are confidently recommended as a really serviceable material.

BROWN, EWING & Co.

respectfully suggest an early inspection of these decided Bargains. The quality is such that it cannot fail to secure a very rapid sale.

1694 Yards Ladies' Dress Tweed, 1s 6d.
2173 Yards Ladies' Dress Tweed, 1s 9d.
2016 Yards Ladies' Dress Tweed, 1s 11d.

N.B.—These Goods are honestly worth Three Shillings and Sixpence per yard.

PATTERNS FREE by POST upon APPLICATION.

PRINCES-STREET, DUNEDIN.

JAMES MUIR,

HAT AND CAP MANUFACTURER.
No. 16, PRINCES-STREET, DUNEDIN,
(Opposite Begg's Music Saloon.)

ALL kinds of Hats and Caps made to order on the Shortest Notice.

For a faithfully built Hat, go to
JAMES MUIR!

Support the Honest Man.

THE PUBLIC TRUST OFFICE OF NEW ZEALAND.

ATTENTION is directed to the provisions of the Acts establishing this Office, and to the advantages placed thereby within the reach of every colonist.

Subject to such provisions, the State offers to every person:—

1. About to make his or her will or codicil.

2. Intending to provide for wife and children or others by deed of settlement.

3. Settling property by way of marriage settlement.

4. Desiring to renounce the trusts of a will having been appointed Executor or Trustee under the same.

5. Having acted as Trustee, Executor, or Administrator, and wishing to be relieved of the burthen of Trusteeship or Administration, the option of using the State machinery, and gives an absolute guarantee against loss of funds by fraud or dishonesty.

Every information may be obtained from

ALEX. BATHGATE,
Agent at Dunedin;

or from

R. C. HAMERTON,
Public Trustee.

Wellington, 27th April, 1884.

FOR SALE.

FOR SALE, Sections 41 and 64, block VIII., Akatore, containing 242 acres. Very small deposit required, and purchaser can have any reasonable time to pay up balance of purchase money. Title under Land Transfer Act. Apply

DONALD REID,
Solicitor, Milton.

NEW ADVERTISEMENTS.

A. & J. M'FARLANE,

PRINCESS AND MACLAGGAN-STREETS,
DUNEDIN.

ONLY holders of Reynolds' Favorite Wines.

	Per doz. s.	d.
PORTS, from	45	0
Very rich old Port, Vintage 1874 ...	70	0
Amontillado, superior dry; the finest ever introduced into this Colony...	80	0
Royal, very superior fruity, full-bodied Wine	45	0
RICH COLONIAL WINES.		
Grenachee Rich Red Burgundy ...	30	0
Port, good family wine	30	0
Frontignac, a dessert wine	35	0
Tokay, white, round and nice flavor	30	0
Muscadine, white, a dessert wine ...	35	0
WHISKIES.		
Teacher and Sons' 11-year-old, per gal. proof	28	0
Old Highland, well-matured, per gal. proof	28	0
Superior old Glenury Whisky (per case)	40	0

Colonial Hams and Bacon, 8d to 1s per lb.
Cheese, Colonial, rich and old, 8d and 9d per lb.

WOOL. WOOL. WOOL.

TO WOOL GROWERS FARMERS AND OTHERS.

WE have much pleasure in again announcing that we shall hold Auction Sales of Wool every Week throughout the season. Account sales will be rendered and proceeds paid over promptly within Six Days of the Sale.

We act as Selling Brokers only, and make careful valuation of every lot, large or small, prior to the sale, and as every department of the business is conducted under our personal supervision, the best guarantee is afforded to consignors that no lot will be sold below its full market value, and that their interests generally will be thoroughly protected.

Our stores offer advantages for the display of the wools, which must ensure the highest values being obtained.

The charges on Wool offered for sale and not sold are nominal, being One Shilling per Bale Only, which includes receiving, warehousing, and delivering. No storage charged on lots held over, and no commission charged on lots unsold. All produce is held fully covered by insurance during the time it is in store

Our arrangements are such that all goods consigned to us at Dunedin will be forwarded at once to our stores, whether advised or not, and will receive our utmost attention upon arrival.

We are prepared to make liberal cash advances at the lowest possible rates on growing clips, or on Wool consigned to us for sale either in Dunedin or to our agents in London.

Wool Packs, Corn Sacks, and Station Stores supplied at the lowest rates.

DONALD REID & CO.,
Auctioneers, Stock and Station Agents, and Wool Brokers,
HIGH STREET, DUNEDIN.

READ IT ALL.

IT MAY SAVE YOUR LIFE.

HOP BITTERS
ARE
THE PUREST AND BEST
Medicine ever made.

THEY ARE COMPOUNDED FROM
Hops, Buchu, Mandrake, and Dandelion,
"The Oldest, Best, most Renowned, 'and Valuable Medicines in the World, 'and in addition contain all the best 'and most effective curative properties 'of all other bitters, being the greatest 'Liver Regulator, BLOOD PURIFIER 'and life and health restoring agent on 'earth."

THEY GIVE NEW LIFE AND VIGOR TO THE AGED AND INFIRM.

"To Clergymen, Lawyers, Literary 'Men, Labourers, Ladies and all those 'whose sedentary employments cause 'irregularities of the Blood, Stomach, 'Bowels, or Kidneys, or who require an 'Appetizer, Tonic, and mild Stimulant 'these Bitters are invaluable, being 'highly curative, tonic and stimulating, 'without intoxicating."

"No matter what your feelings or 'symptoms are, or what the disease or 'ailment is, use Hop Bitters. Don't 'wait until you are sick, but if you only 'feel bad or miserable, use the Bitters at 'once. It may save your life. Hundreds have been saved by so doing, at 'a trifling cost.

ASK YOUR DRUGGIST OR PHYSICIAN.

"Do not suffer yourself or let your 'friends suffer, but use and urge them to 'use Hop Bitters."

"Remember, Hop Bitters is no vile, 'drugged, drunken nostrum, but the 'purest and best Medicine ever made, 'and no person or family should be 'without it."

HOP BITTERS MANUFACTURING CO.,
Melbourne, Australia, Rochester, N. Y. U. S. A., Toronto, London, Antwerp, Paris.

GLACIALINE FOR KEEPING MILK MEAT FISH ETC. IN THE HOTTEST WEATHER. SOLD BY GROCERS & STOREKEEPERS.

Agents:—
MESSRS KINROSS & Co.,
Napier

NEW ADVERTISEMENTS.

TO THE ELECTORS OF THE ELECTORAL DISTRICT OF BRUCE.

GENTLEMEN,—Being determined to close my Grand Consultation on or before the 28th July, 1884, I am sorry I cannot offer myself as a Candidate for your suffrages at the forthcoming General Election.

I am, gentlemen, your, &c.,
"FORTUNA."

FORTUNA'S GRAND NOVEL CONSULTATION.

3000 SHARES AT £1 EACH.

To be DRAWN positively on or before 28th JULY.

LAST MONTH! APPLY EARLY!
LAST MONTH! APPLY EARLY!

27 PRIZES, as follows:—

1st prize—The Farm and Homestead (approved value)	£2500
2nd prize—Cash award	200
3rd " " "	100
4th " " "	50
5th " " "	25
6th " " "	15
7th " " "	10
And 20 " " at £5	100
	£3000

This beautiful property is situated in the Shag Valley District, no great distance from the railway, containing several hundred acres of superior wheat growing land, well fenced and subdivided, and partly laid down in English grass, a never-failing stream of water running through the property.

The Homestead comprises a well-built villa residence, with first-class stabling and out-buildings. The garden is well laid out, and contains several hundred choice full-bearing fruit trees and ornamental shrubs.

The freehold of this magnificent estate will be handed over and legally transferred, free of any encumbrance whatever, to the successful shareholder the day after the drawing.

£1000 OR MORE

will be lent on the property, at 7 per cent, interest if required.

A Committee of Shareholders will be appointed to supervise the drawing.

Members of the Press will be invited to be present, as also any Shareholder who may be so disposed.

Programmes, £1 each, to be had on application by letter only, with two stamps enclosed for reply and result.

Cheques to be made payable to number or bearer; and, if country, add 1s exchange. Bank notes, or P. O. Orders, payable to "Fortuna," preferred. Registered letters or telegrams not accepted.

As a large number of shares have already been applied for, early application is necessary.

Address—"FORTUNA."
Care of F. W. REICHELT,
Post Office, Palmerston, Otago.

N.B.—Please write the name and address full and legibly.

SPORTING NEWS.

FOURTH GRAND DRAWING IS NOW OPEN!

THE Three previous Drawings were filled a week prior to the advertised date of closing.

The Public of New Zealand have appreciated these Grand Hamburg Drawings, therefore the Company anticipate having their Fifth Drawing on a larger scale.

This Fourth Grand Drawing for £3000 will close about the end of August, and the Fifth Drawing will Open on the 1st September.

The large number of applications (over 900) that came too late will be duly registered for this Fourth Drawing.

This Fourth Drawing will consist of 240 MONEY PRIZES amounting to £3000, subscribed by 6000 members at 10s each.

The various Money Prizes will be distributed as follows:—

1 £300 PRIZE	10 £25 PRIZES
1 £150 PRIZE	10 £20 PRIZES
1 £100 PRIZE	10 £15 PRIZES
2 £50 PRIZES	120 £10 PRIZES
5 £30 PRIZES	80 £5 PRIZES

Total amount, £3000. 240 Money Prizes.

The grand principle of these Hamburg Drawings is that a purchaser of 25 Programmes is guaranteed a Prize, as it is so drawn that a prize must come out to every 25 numbers, and the chances are in favor of the investor drawing a large prize, as there are 160 large prizes against 80 small ones. To any investor of £2 the chances are only 6 to 1 against him drawing a prize, and the Head Prize or any other may be drawn by any investor of 10s.

The Company would not presume to tell the public that they have a number of chances and can win a number of prizes for a single investment of 10s.

The large bulk of the Money in this Grand Drawing is not given away in one big prize, as it is in the Horse Consultations, but you will observe in this Hamburg Drawing that the £3000 is fairly proportioned into 240 PRIZES, giving every shareholder an equal chance of getting a good prize.

This Hamburg Drawing is one of the most novel, and will be conducted on the fairest principle possible, so as to give entire public satisfaction.

This Fourth Drawing for £3000 will take place under the supervision of a committee of eight gentlemen, and the prizes will be paid over as early as possible after the drawing.

NOTICE.—Country Cheques marked correct by Bank, only payable to a number, and 1s added for exchange. P. O. Orders preferred, made payable only to BOAZ. Bank Notes accepted. Two 2d stamps for reply and result. Registered letters and telegrams not received.

Name and address of applicant should be plainly written.

All letters must be addressed

BOAZ,
Care MR MOSLEY,
Wholesale and Retail Tobacconist,
Box 64 P. O., Dunedin

BUSINESS NOTICES.

JOHN EDIE,

CIVIL ENGINEER & SURVEYOR,

HAS commenced business on his own account, and hopes to meet with a fair share of public support.

Licensed under the "Land Transfer Act."

Agent for
NORTH BRITISH MERCANTILE INSURANCE COMPANY.

ADDRESS:
Spencer-street, Milton.

ROBERT GRIGOR,

SURVEYOR, VALUATOR, &c.
BALCLUTHA.

Hotels, Estates, &c., valued.

TERMS ON APPLICATION.

VULCAN FOUNDRY.

GREAT KING STREET, DUNEDIN.

KINCAID, M'QUEEN & CO., Boiler-makers, Engineers, Millwrights, Founders, Blacksmiths, &c. All kinds of Castings in Brass and Iron; Steam Engines and Boilers made and Repaired; Overshot, Breast, and Turbine Water Wheels; Quartz Crushing Machinery; Pumping and Winding Gear; Cast-Iron Sluice and Ripple Plates; Sheet Iron Hopper and Sluice Plates punched to any size of hole. Gold Dredging Spoons, etc.; Flour Mill Machinery, and all kinds of Reaping, Threashing, and Horse-power Machines made and repaired. Improved Reaping Machines. Superior Flax Dressing Machines, capable on Dressing from 25 to 30 cwt. fibre per week. All Machines tried before leaving the Works Purchasers can see the Machines working o their premises.

THE GOLD MEDAL
"BUTTER-WORKERS."

A SHIPMENT just landed. Some of them "POWER'S WORKERS. Also by the same vessel, some BUTTER PRINTERS.

AND TO ARRIVE,—
Butter Workers, "Cooley" Creamers, Printers, and
DAVIS' SWING CHURNS,
found to surpass any now in use, easier to work, to keep clean, and quicker to do the churning.

W. D. SUTHERLAND,
George-street, Dunedin.

MORRIS,

ART PHOTOGRAPHER,
175, George-street, Dunedin.
(Late Firm CLIFFORD & MORRIS).

EVERY SITTER is Photographed by Mr Morris, personally, and the reputation he holds as an artist is a guarantee for the most artistic and best finished Photographs that can possibly be made.

MONEY TO LEND.

SEVERAL Sums of MONEY from £100 to £1000 to lend on Freehold Security, at lowest rate of interest. Apply to

DONALD REID,
Solicitor,
Milton.

GRATEFUL—COMFORTING

EPPS'S COCOA BREAKFAST.

"By a thorough knowledge of the natural laws which govern the operations of digestion and nutrition, and by a careful application of the fine properties of well-selected cocoa, Mr Epps has provided our breakfast tables with a delicately flavored beverage which may save us many heavy dotcors' bills It is by the judicious use of such articles of diet that a constitution may be gradually built up until strong enough to resist every tendency to disease. Hundreds of subtle maladies are floating around us ready to attack wherever there is a weak point. We may escape many a fatal shaft by keeping ourselves well fortified with pure blood and a properly nourished frame."—See article in 'Civil Service Gazette.'

Made simply with boiling water or milk.

Sold only in packets (tins for abroad), labelled

JAMES EPPS & CO.,
HOMŒOPATHIC CHEMISTS,
LONDON.

Also—Epps's Chocolate Essence for afternoon use.

NOTICE.

PROOF OF DEBT Forms on Sale the Office of this Paper.

Selected Poetry.

WAITING.

See that beauteous maiden there,
Tripping gaily o'er the green;
She is hasting o'er to where
Her lover, I, have waiting been.

Yes, she's hasting o'er to me!
For she knows that I am here,
Waiting, 'neath the trysting tree—
Watching, till she may appear!

Saw you e'er such beauty rare
Gracing this lov'd earth of ours?
And she's true as she is fair—
Pure as are the dew-laved flowers!

O, ye zephyrs! as she seeks
Me, beneath this tree-shade gloom,
Softly blow upon her cheeks—
Blow the roses into bloom!

Kiss but sparingly her lips—
Steal not all the sweets away;
For I'm jealous of the sips—
Leave them all for me to-day.

With her hair of golden wealth
Play not harshly, as it streams;
Set her eyes aglow with health,
Soon I'll bask beneath their beams.

For she's hasting o'er to me,
Well she knows that I am here
Waiting, 'neath the trysting tree—
Watching, till she may appear!

Vive Vale.

MINNIE.

Let artists enraptured by toil and by art
Display types of beauty ideal in their heart,
While I, a poor bardie, can only enshrine
And sing of sweet Minnie who's centred in mine.

Great masters of music there are and have been,
Who've turned their best notes in praise of some queen;
But had they once seen her, I vow and declare,
Young Minnie had moved them to efforts more rare.

Old Homer has told us how Helen of Troy
Bewitched all the Greeks, who did armies destroy;
Her beauty, no doubt, was entrancing and rare,
But never surpassed pretty Minnie's I'll swear.

The sculptor, for months, he may chisel and chip,
Perfecting a head, leg, arm, or a lip;
Yet vain all his labour—stone never can be
So warm as fair Minnie, or graceful as she.

A painter will daub, and re-daub for a year,
Some ideal vision to limn and make clear;
Then change, and re-change, for some new airy flame,
But Minnie's perfection, and ever the same.

C. M'Millan.

A FEMALE CRUSOE.

The San Francisco *Call* contains an interesting account of an Indian woman who was accidentally abandoned on Sau Nicolas Island, off the coast of Southern California, and spent eighteen years alone there before she was rescued. The fact of her existence was discovered by a man who went from the mainland to hunt for otters, and who found footprints deeply sunk in the ground. He was unable to follow up these indications till nearly three years, when one of a party who accompanied him came suddenly upon the object of their search. She was in a small circular enclosure made of brushwood, about 5ft. high and 6ft. in diameter, with a small opening on one side. She was clothed with a garment made of skins of the shag, a species of duck that can neither walk nor fly. This garment reached almost to her ankles when she stood erect. She was sitting cross-legged, skinning seal-blubber with a rude knife made of a piece of hoop iron driven into a piece of wood. There was no covering on her head, except a thick matted mass of hair, of yellowish-brown colour, probably owing to exposure to the sun and the weather; it was short, as if the ends had rotted off. There were some wild dogs on the island, a few of which kept near her, and seemed to regard her as a mistress. She had lived on a plant resembling cabbage, called by Californians *palo santo*, and a root known by the name of *correomite*, also blubber of the various kinds of seals, &c. She had a rude apparatus for catching shellfish, and strong fishing lines made of seal sinews, which seemed to indicate that she fished in the ocean. The expression of her face was pleasing, her features were regular, her complexion much fairer and her form more symmetrical than that of the Indian women on the adjoining mainland. Some suspect that she belonged to a tribe much further north. She could not understand anything said to her in any of the Indian dialects of South California, but she had a wonderful capacity for conversing by signs. She retained all her teeth, but they were worn low, supposed to be due to her chewing tough and hard articles of food. Her age appeared to be about 50 years. She bowed to all who came near her, greeting them with a smile. She freely accompanied her discoverers to their vessel, but her conduct at once convinced them that she retained the virtue of female modesty. She showed singular dexterity in making water-vessels from grass and asphaltum, a substance which is plentiful both on the island and the mainland. She seemed to recognise various appliances of civilisation. She died about seven weeks after reaching the mainland, partly from the effects of a fall, partly from dysentery, brought on by eating fruits and vegetables. Padre Gonzalez, the superior of the mission of Santa Barbara, has sent her dress of shagskins, her basket and implements to Rome, to the Museum of the Propaganda.

A NEW ORNITHOLOGICAL FACT

A correspondent, dating from Follett Lodge, Topsham, writes to the *Standard*: I can vouch for the accuracy of the following narrative, which exhibits a new trait in bird nature interesting to the psycho-evolutionist as well as to the general public. The late Dr. Spence, editor of the *Evangelical Magazine*, allowed his kindly nature to be at one time much engaged in the contemplation and protection of a pet Robin. This friendly if not pugnacious songster has been accustomed to visit his friend daily about meal times, and having eaten with them, to reward his hosts with a little post-prandial music before again taking flight. On one of these incursions he introduced another bright eyed intruder, who gradually became as confiding a visitor as any lover of birds could wish. Attracted by this pair's frequent visit to the cornice, Dr. Spence mounted a pair of steps, and there, snugly ensconsed, discovered the foundations of a nest this enterprising couple were projecting. The window was now left constantly open, and after a short time the nest was finished, and four little mottled eggs deposited, while the clear intelligent eyes of the sitting bird might generally be seen gazing fearlessly at the occupants of the apartment. After about a fortnight had elapsed the male Robin entered one day as usual, and flying to the nest immediately began a series of shrill cries, flying round and round the room in its excitement, but finally settling upon the top of the pier glass carolled forth a song. Fearing that some giant spider had invaded the little home, an examination was made, and there in their helpless nudity lay four little birds, about whose arrival into this world their father had shown such animated glee. But now was the serious occurrence. After a day or two the parents of these little hopefuls introduced a third robin, who proceeded immediately to assist the other two in their parental duties, even to instructing the little ones in their first infantile flight. Whether this was some unfortunate, widowed by thoughtless boys of mate and nest, or whether it was an initiation of some youthful Robin into the mysteries of baby feeding, the proper alternation of vegetable and animal food (for the pugnacious Robin is no vegetarian) and the necessary restraint to be imposed upon the eager little appetites, has not been mine to know. I have, however, conversed with those who actually witnessed this little life scene, and I would respectfully suggest that a systematic gentle study of the inner life of those beings who breathe with us the common air may reveal natural depths of knowledge of which the scientist in his merciless but barren search for the principle that directs the being can never dream.

ABOUT LEAP YEAR.

Leap Year, or Bissextile, is defined in the dictionary as "Every fourth year, and so called from its leaping a day more that year than in a common year; so that a common year has 365 days, but a leap year 366; and then February has 29 days, which in common years has but 28." A popular and ready way of finding leap year is to divide the year of our Lord by four. The year 1880 is a leap year; but is every year that can be divided by four a leap year? A year is exactly 365 days, 5 hours, 48 minutes, 49 seconds, and 7-10ths of a second. Julius Cæsar, about 45 years before Christ, fixed the astronomical year at 365¼ days exactly. To fit the civil reckoning with the astronomical, a day in February, the sixth before the calends (the first day of every month among the Romans) of March (Sextilis) was to be repeated in that fourth year; and each fourth year was thus to be Bissextile: hence the name of Bissextile given to leap year, or years of 366 days. It was as if the 23rd of February were reckoned twice over. But this was too much by 11 minutes 13 seconds and 3-10ths of a second. Pope Gregory found in 1582, that from the Council of Nice in 325 there had been an over-reckoning of ten days. To correct this error he decreed that the 5th of October that year should be the 15th October; and there being still an overplus of 18 hours 37 minutes and 10 seconds in a century, to keep correct with the stars for all time to come, he ordered that every centurial year that could not be divided by four (1700, 1800, 1900, 2200, 2300, &c.) should not be Bissextile or leap year, as it otherwise would have been. The years 2000, 2400, &c. would still be leap years. It was not until 1782 that the Gregorian calendar was adopted in England, and it is not adopted in Russia even yet. An Act of Parliament was passed in that year, enacting that the 3rd of September should be reckoned the 14th, and that three of every four of the centurial years should, as in Pope Gregory's arrangement, not be leap years. The year 1751, like the years preceding, had commenced in England on the 25th of March; the A.D., therefore, ought to have changed on the 25th of March following. But it was changed earlier, in order to be in accordance with Continental nations. The English year 1751 was never completed; from the 1st of January, 1751, they called it 1752. The year 1751, therefore, lost the whole of its months of January and February, and the first 24 days of March. Lord Chesterfield, who proposed the measure in the House of Lords, was very near falling a victim to the anger of the mob, who followed him about, shouting, "Give us our three months back again!"

Scientific and Useful.

A NEW THEORY OF DEW.

Investigations which Professor Stockbridge has made at the Amherst Agricultural College upon the comparative temperatures of the soil and air, and the deposition of dew upon the earth and plants, have led him to conclusions very different from those commonly received in regard to the formation of dew. It is usually held that dew is the moisture of the air, condensed through contact with objects of a lower temperature, and that it does not form until radiation has reduced the temperature of the earth and other objects below that of the atmosphere. The experiments referred to seem to indicate that, as regards objects in the immediate vicinity of the earth, at least, the process is the converse of this—viz, that the dew is the result of condensation by the air of warm vapour as it rises from the soil.

LUMINOUS PAPER.

This paper may with great advantage be used for various useful purposes—such as, among others, for match-box labels, luggage labels, labels for bottles (especially for bottles containing poisons), labels for crates containing fragile goods, which, by being thus distinguished, will be rendered less liable to rough treatment when being moved about on dark nights; also for wall-paper, designs blocked upon which may be highly ornamented, while such paper will be serviceable for lighting up to a useful extent passages and chambers, especially water-closets and other places, wherein only moderate light is required; for writing paper and envelopes, business, private, and Christmas cards, and for advertisements, and especially for railway coach tablets, which, affixed to the ceilings and backs of compartments, will serve the two-fold purpose of producing prominent announcements and rendering the carriage sufficiently light to enable lamps to be dispensed with when passing through tunnels during the daytime.

ACETATE OF SODA CAR HEATERS.

A new method of warming street cars has been on trial for some time past on the De Kalb Avenue line in Brooklyn. About seventy cars have been fitted up with the appliance, which is a very simple one, and does not encroach on the seating room for passengers. Two pipes run under the seats on each side, charged with a composition of acetate of soda, which at each trip is heated by a jet of steam sent through from a stationary boiler at the stable. The compound being heated, is dissolved into liquid, and upon cooling throws out into the car the heat stored in it. The heat is pleasant and moist, without being intense enough to be disagreeable, is sufficiently strong for passengers to enjoy with ordinary cut of door wraps, the temperature by actual record being maintained at 40 degrees higher than that outside the car. Thus, if the thermometer is down to twenty degrees above zero, the average temperature of the cars is kept at sixty degrees above.

THEY ALL KNEW HOW.

A writer in the *Portland Press* says that he took a spider from his web, put him on a chip, and set him afloat on the quiet waters of the pond. "He walked all about the sides of the bark, surveying the situation very carefully, and when the fact that he was really afloat and about a yard from shore seemed to be fully comprehended, he prospected for the nearest point of land. This point fairly settled upon, he immediately began to cast a web for it. He threw it as far as possible in the air and with the wind. It soon reached the shore and made fast to the spires of grass. Then he turned himself about and in true sailor fashion began to haul in hand over hand on his cable. Carefully he drew upon it until his bark began to move toward the shore. As it moved the faster, the faster he drew upon it, to keep his hawser taut, and from touching the water. Very soon he reached the shore, and quickly leaping to terra firma, he sped his way homeward. Thinking, then, that he might be a special expert, and an exception in that line of boatmanship to the rest of his companions, I tried several of them, and all came to shore in like manner.

THE ICHNEUMON FLY.

The majority of these insects are, in their earlier stages, parasitic upon the Lepidoptera, or butterflies and moths, which they usually seek in the caterpillar state. Having found a suitable caterpillar, the ichneumon fly mounts its back, and, bending its own body, brings its ovipositor down on the surface of the unsuspecting grub. By a little pressure the sharp point of the borer is driven through the poor creature's skin, producing, however, apparently, no greater discomfort at the time than a slight tickling sensation. The perforation made, an egg is inserted into the body of the victim sufficiently far to prevent the possibility of its removal with the skin when the caterpillar effects its periodical moults. Frequently a large number of eggs are laid in a single caterpillar, but in many cases only one is deposited, the number depending in large measure upon the size of the ichneumons they are destined to produce, a matter requiring careful attention, as the supply of food is limited to what is or will be contained within the body of the caterpillar. From the moment of the insertion of the egg, the caterpillar is a doomed being, though for a long time there may be no premonitions of its fate. The ichneumon grubs, which soon hatch from the eggs, as soft, white, fleshy creatures with cylindrical bodies and without feet, devour the stores of fat laid up by their host, which it was intended to use in the elaboration of the additional organs of its own future form. These depredations, however, do not affect any vital part, and the creature goes on living, eating, and growing, while the insidious parasites are also flourishing upon the store of nutriment with which it unintentionally provides them. Matters go on thus until the ichneumon grubs are nearly ready to assume the pupa state, a period in their growth which sometimes almost synchronises with the corresponding state in their host. When this is the case the latter has by this time begun to manifest symptoms of discomfort and disease, ceasing to eat, and becoming more and more feeble until it finally dies of exhaustion, when the parasites eat their way through its skin, and, on reaching the outside, form cocoons to protect themselves in the pupa state, which they group round the carcase of the caterpillar whose vitality has now passed into their own bodies. So the development of the caterpillar is arrested before it can enter the chrysalis stage, and it therefore never fullils its destiny. More generally, however, the ichneumon maggots do not mature quite so quickly, and the larva manages to pupate before they make their exit from its body. Still the result is in the end the same; the creature dies prematurely, never reaching the stage in which it can provide for the perpetuation of its race, and so passes away "without issue." Now, as the caterpillars of the Lepidoptera are almost exclusively devourers of vegetable substances, the ichneumon flies, by preventing their too rapid increase, become the saviour of vegetation, and may therefore be welcomed by the agriculturist.

Our Novelettes.

THE HEIR OF PAYTONS.

(By the Author of "Estelle's Error," &c.)

Chapter V.—*Concluded.*

'Yes,' was Frank's reply. 'She can't bear to hear his name even from me. I know nothing of him, except that he died in Sicily when I was quite a baby. Ah, Maud, there never was a more perfect mother than mine.'

'Frand, Frank, my boy, do not say that!' And Mrs Dayrell, who had approached unperceived, sank on her knees by his couch, and rested her head on his shoulder. 'Oh, my darling, you will hate and despise me when you know all! But I have loved you, Frank, as few children are loved.'

She pressed a lingering kiss on his cheek, while her hot tears fell fast, and, rising, hurried from the room before he could speak. With a rapid, unsteady step she passed along the passage and down the broad stairs, and entered Sir Arthur's study. He was sitting in the evening sunlight, wrapped in thought, and rose to his feet with a start as she entered.

'What is the matter?' he cried, eagerly. 'Frank is not worse?'

'No, not worse,' she answered, drearily. 'He is out of all danger now, and can spare me. You gave me leave to stay in your house only while his life was in danger; and now I am come to bid you farewell. I know you mean to keep him and to tell him the dreadful tale that will part nim from me for ever. I do not murmur. I have deserved it all, and to give you up my one treasure now is the only reparation I can make. I feel that it will kill me; but what matters my life? Yet, when my last hour comes, and I send for him, let him—if he will—come and close my eyes. It is all I ask, Arthur—a little boon—oh, do not refuse it!' She paused, for her trembling accents had died away to a whisper, and she could say no more.

Sir Arthur's face was ashy-pale, and his whole form trembling with strong emotion; but with a great effort he controlled his voice to say coldly—

'I will promise you that.'

'Heaven bless you for that!' she returned, clasping her hands tightly together. 'I am going now, Arthur. I dare not ask you for one word of forgiveness to take with me in my loneliness—I have wronged you too deeply. But my punishment has been very, very severe. When that wild infatuation passed away, my love for you returned, and has added a poignancy to my shame and grief during these long, long years of which you can know nothing. Farewell, Arthur—be both father and mother to my boy, and may Heaven be to you what you are to him!'

She turned, and tottered to the door. Sir Arthur's lips opened to speak, but no sound came, and the door closed behind her. Then he cried aloud, 'Melaine, my wife!' But she did not hear, and he rushed to the door to call her back. She lay at the threshold, still and senseless, and, lifting her in his arms, he laid her on the couch, and, locking the door, kneit down by her.

'Melaine, speak to me!' he cried, horsely. 'I forgive you all—only open your eyes and show me you are not dead! Oh, Melaine, my life's love, I cannot help myself—I love you still in spite of all!' The words seemed to rouse her fainting senses, and the large blue eyes rested inquiringly on his face. 'It is true, Melaine!' he cried again. 'I love you still! You shall stay with me for ever. I have fought hard with myself ever since I first saw you, but love was too strong for me. I cannot give you up again, my lost one, my one love!' He folded her in his arms, and pressed fond, eager kisses on her white face, while she murmured through her tears—

'Oh, Arthur, my husband, it is more than I dare believe!'

It was lucky he had locked the door, for at that moment the handle was turned. Sir Arthur sprang to his feet and his wife sat up.

'Who is there?' he asked angrily, and, striding to the door, he threw it open, and met his brother face to face.

Mr Horace Denver looked from one to the other, and his bland smile died away.

'I am sorry to interrupt you,' he said, stiffly, 'but I did not expect to find Mrs Dayrell in your study.'

'Probably not,' returned Sir Arthur, coolly; 'and you perhaps did not expect to find that the lady you have called Mrs Dayrell is my wife, and has been for the last eight-and-twenty years. You will understand now why Maud is allowed by her mother to remain here; for my son and the heir of Paytons is a widely different man from an unknown 'fortune-hunter,' as you kindly described him.'

'I shall dispute it!' shouted Mr Denver, nearly purple with rage. 'It is a falsehood from beginning to end! I shall go to law, and get my rights!'

And so he did go to law—ay, and got his rights, which were to leave Paytons and return to the moderate house and income he had formerly enjoyed; while his son Arthur, a grave and saddened man, departed to begin a new life on the other side of the world. He never recovered from the terrible anxiety of those few days, for, though the shot had in reality been purely accidental, he knew it would have been very difficult to prove it so, and he might have stood before the world as the murderer of his rival.

Maud married Frank Denver, but was not Lady Denver of Paytons until her eldest daughter was engaged to the son of general Chaloner—for both Sir Arthur and his wife were so happy in their reunion that years passed lightly over their heads. Maud's mother, after her daughter's marriage, resigned the dower-house and took up her abode in London, resuming her place among her old friends and acquaintances, and seeking with avidity the gaiety and excitement for which Maud had very little taste.

However, Frank was too proud of his beautiful wife to let her bury nerself in the country, and their time was equally divided between London and Paytons, though she laughingly declared that she dared not remain very long at the latter place, as her children were so terribly spoilt by their grandfather and grandmother, especially the dark-eyed, handsome boy who was now the heir of Paytons.

M.L.P.

AN OLD WOMAN'S STORY.

I don't know that I can tell my story properly now that I have set about the task, for I am but an old woman, and more accustomed to wield a darning-needle than a pen; and so, though I have plenty of ideas in my head—such as they are—and know perfectly well what I should like to say, it is not so easy, I find, to clothe one's ideas in a suitable dress when one's tongue must be silent, and thoughts have only a scrap of paper upon which to spring into maturify. However, I will do my best, and that is as much as any can be expected to do, is it not?

To begin, then. My name is Margaret—Margaret Gray—and the state of life into which I have been called is that of an 'old maid.' And I think I can hardly be designated egotistical, when I affirm that I have no more vinegar or other so-called 'ingredients of spinsterhood' in my composition than the rest of my somewhat abused tribe.

Poor folk are in the habit of saying that Miss Gray's broths and cordials are matters by no means to be despised; but, if you asked them anything about good looks, it is my impression they would laugh very heartily at your questions. Years ago—I am almost afraid to think of them and reckon them up, there have been so many—thirty, I think—my father died; and not many months after, my mother, pining for the partner with whom she had passed so many and such happy peaceful days, followed him to rest in the little green churchyard, and we were left—Gerard, Eustace, and I—almost alone in the world. We had a few relatives but they were distantly connected, and lived far away from Greenvale, the little village in which we had resided all our lives. Not that we cared about our apparent loneliness; we had plenty of good-hearted, simple-minded friends around us, and we were left, if not rich, yet with ample means for our moderate tastes and requirements. My father had been the partner of old Dr. Lesley, and was highly beloved by the parishioners, not many of whom were there but had experienced his kindness and skill in come way or another.

At this period I was about eighteen, and the twin boys were ten or eleven—Gerard being the elder, it was affirmed, by virtue of priority of birth to the extent of perhaps three minutes. The child born a year or two after me died in infancy, so that, being in my own opinion so much the senior of my brothers, and so very much wiser, I patronised them immensely in our childish days; and I suppose it was because of that that they invariably appealed to me in their little disputes, and regarded me quite in the light of a guardian. I loved them very dearly, and was only too delighted to become the recipient of their tales of woe or joy; and, as they grew into manhood, it was my pride and joy to know that the 'boys' still came to 'Margaret' for advice or sympathy.

Until they were three years old, Gerard and Eustace grew as it were neck and neck, straight as arrows, lithe and supple; there could not have been a fairer, handsomer pair of boys in the world—at least I thought so, and I know my father and mother, together with the whole village shared my opinion. Then one day—never shall I forget that terrible day—the young girl who had been hired to attend upon the children, and accompany them in their rambles, was seen rushing almost breathlessly along the quiet dusty street leading to our house, shouting incoherently of some dreadful disaster that had befallen someone.

My mother and I were just emerging from our garden—she with a book and camp-stool, and I with my doll—on our way to the shady woods a little distance from the village.

'What is it, child?' old Doctor Lesley, who was passing us, called out. 'Do not be in such a hurry to speak. Come now, what has happened?' and he patted the servant kindly on the back.

But my mother, all her maternal fears aroused, turned pale as death as she opened our gate, and, taking the girl's shaking hands, said quietly, but with an agony in her tone that even I could detect—

'Is it the children, Martha?'

'Yes, ma'am—yes, ma'am; but—oh, it was not my fault! I—I——'

Here Martha stopped, and began wringing her hands and moaning.

A little cry broke from my mother's lips; and Doctor Lesley, stepping towards her, gently pulled her arm through his—for she could scarcely support herself.

'Now, Martha,' he said, sternly, 'no more nonsense—what has happened? Speak, child; we are losing valuable time.'

So between her sobs and moans Martha managed at least to explain that the children had been playing with much mirth in the old Hollow, a favourite resort of theirs, when Master Gerard proposed that they should try to climb the big sycamore close by. By the help of the hollow parts of the tree they managed to get upon a low, strong-looking branch, when suddenly it broke, both children tumbling off as a matter of course. Master Gerard jumped up laughing and shouting, but Master Eustace lay perfectly still and could not rise. And here Martha broke down again. She was afraid he was "dreadful bad;" he couldn't move, and his face was so white.

I shall never forget the least incident connected with that day; everything seems indeliby fixed upon my memory.

We hurried off to the old Hollow quickly enough—my mother walking—in her intense eagerness to see her injured child—almost too fast for the nimble doctor to keep pace with. Eustace lay there precisely, Martha said, in the position in which she had left him.

There is no need to go into further details of that miserable day. Suffice it to say that the poor little fellow was carried tenderly and gently home by loving hands, and laid in his crib, his poor face whiter than the snowy curtains surrounding it, and that the verdict—listened for so anxiously—that fell from my father's trembling lips was that Eustace would not die, but—and both he and Doctor Leeley hesitated to subdue the light that broke over my mother's sad face—that he would be deformed, his spine having received a severe injury.

'Heaven's will be done—my darling, my noble boy!' she said, brokenly—'but it is hard—it is hard.'

She was standing by the little bed, pressing her hands tightly together and striving desperately to make no outward sign of grief. I stood weeping silently beside her, and, when everybody had left the room, leaving her and me alone with the suffere. she tuaned suddenly to me, saying—

'Margaret, child, let me give you a charge to keep.' Never forsake him'—and she laid her hand gently on the little one thrust outside the bedclothes—'watch over him and care for him, for perhaps I may not live till he grows up. Do you comprehend me, dear?'

I did perfectly, and I don't know what audible reply I made, but I know that in my heart I vowed to watch over and never forsake my poor little crippled brother. I thank providence from my heart that it has been placed in my power to keep my childish promise. There was a time when Margaret Gray, plain and homely-looking as she was thought, might have saved herself, had she so chosen, from having her name recorded in the 'old maid's' list. I do not regret it; I have had my reward, if there has been any self-denial in the case, in the great love and almost reverence with which 'the boys 'regard me.

No other incident of any moment ruffled our calm, peaceful lives, until the death of our parents. I think I have mentioned that I was about eighteen at that sorrowful time. When my mother died, she bade me remember, almost with her last breath, the promise I had made her years ago. There was no fear that I should forget it; I loved the poor deformed boy too dearly for that.

The twins grew up—at least Gerard grew apace—a tall, well-formed youth—and both were exceedingly handsome. Eustace was short, and he was painfully conscious of his deformity—so conscious that as he grew older it became most difficult for Gerard and myself to get him to accompany us upon any visiting occasions—such as there were about Greenvale, in the shape of a 'tea-drinking' given to the village folk, or the festival held twice a year at our own and a neighbouring vicar's. There were no croquet parties in those days, and archery meetings were quite new amusements; but sometimes ten or a dozen young people would get up a nutting or black-berrying expedition, and we were generally called upon to be of the party.

Eustace never for an instant seemed to forget his great misfortune—not that he ever complained or uttered one word of murmuring, but his face wore continually upon it an expression, many thought of pride, but I knew it to be born of an excessive sensitiveness. How often have I wished in my heart that I could take his burden from him upon myself, when I have seen him shrink, as though a blow had been dealt him, from the curious eyes of a stranger, or at a remark thoughtlessly uttered by some one respecting the cause of his ailment.

I have said we were almost alone in the world, so far as actual relationship existed; but as we had sufficient income to support us without seeking aid from any one, we had no occasion to seek for more friends than we already had. I can never feel sufficiently grateful that we were thus independent of others, for it would have grieved us beyond measure to have had Eustace labouring beyond his strength, as he would most undoubtedly have done—had we been poor.

Both boys desired to be of the same profession as our father, and Dr Lesley, delighted at their choice, took them under his especial care and tuition, his favourite theme of conversation being of the time when there would once more stand 'Lesley and Gray' on the brass plate belonging to the surgery door, instead of the strange name now standing there in the place of our dead father's. The old man, in his enthusiasm and delight, forgot that in all human probability he would never live to see the day he longed for, for he was already past the allotted age of man, although so hale and hearty-looking.

So Gerard went to London — far-off London it was in those days, and a tedious, harassing journey withal—to study under a celebrated man of medicine, and see something of the hospitals, &c.; whilst Eustace, although he would have eagerly joined his brother, listened to my earnest entreaties that he would not leave me. I knew that there was no absolute necessity for his adopting a profession, and I dreaded parting with my charge—a vague horror haunting me that in big, terrible London he would meet with too many mental wounds for his sensitive nature to bear.

So Gerard went to London, and Eustace studied harder than ever with Dr Lesley and Mr Wynne, his present partner.

Time went on; Gerard had been gone nearly a year, and it was close upon his twentieth birthday, and consequently Eustace's. He had written that he should not come home for some time yet, and we were disappointed, for he had said he should pay us a visit before long. Then, as if to take off the edge of our disappointment by giving us something else to think of, there came a stir in our little village, which was like all other little villages in respect of inquisitiveness and gossip.

The Willows—a pretty house, standing detached just beyond the long, old-fashioned street comprisink Greenvale—which had been empty for some time, suddenly became a source of wonder to our good villagers; and I must confess that one Margaret Gray, now really and truly an old maid by virtue of her almost thirty years, was as full of wonderment as any amongst them. We woke up one fine morning to behold the shutters at the windows all thrown back, windows opened wide, and the whole place undergoing a through turn-out; whilst in the garden a man and boy were busily employed in putting the neglected flower-beds in order, and nailing to the house-front the two beautiful rose trees that grew on it. A lady, with her family, from London had taken the house, and that was all anybody could learn.

Nobody knew how they came or when they came, but soon after, one Sunday morning, just as our good Rector was commencing the service, there was a rustle and turning of heads amongst the congregation. It seemed impossible for people to keep their eyes decorously fixed upon their books, when such an unprecedented event was happening under their very noses as strangers walking up the aisle of the little church.

A subdued whisper was audible 'The lady at the Willows.'

And so it was—a pale ladylike-looking woman, worn somewhat, and evidently not in good health, dressed in recent widow's weeds, and looking as though she and sorrow had had much acquaintance with each other. Behind her walked a little girl of ten or thereabouts; and then came so lovely an apparition in the form of a young lady of eighteen—so I judged—that it is a wonder an universal "Oh!" did not escape us. I know our mouths were all quite ready to give it utterance. Just then, however, our worthy clergyman, no doubt noticing our abstraction, and making allowance for it, gave a loud and admonitory "Ahem!" and, blushing for ourselves, we took our eyes from the new arrivals and bent them upon our books.

Happening to glance round at my brother, who usually sat in the far corner of the pew—old-fashioned high pews they were—to see what effect the cause of every one's excitement had had upon him, or whether he remained perfectly stolid, as was usually the case, I literally started with surprise. The whole expression of his face was changed; the worn troubled appearance so habitual to it was gone, and he looked absolutely handsome. He was gazing steadfastly at the young lady from the Willows.

A dreadful fear crept into my heart. Swift as lightning there passed before my mind's eye a panorama of future trouble—trouble only, and no loophole of light in the way of hope.

Eustace seemed fascinated. Involuntarily I thought of the serpent "fixing" its victims with its strange beautiful eyes. My brother seemed perfectly unable to withdraw his from the girl's splendid face. My fixed look at length seemed to penetrate him; he started violently, and the old pained expression, fourfold in its intensity compared to what I had ever seen it before, overshadowed his face, and he almost groaned as he shrank back into his corner.

I understood him perfectly. I read as it were from an open book the agony that I knew was filling his heart at that moment, and which would continue to haunt him. I could have burst into bitter tears for him. My love seemed such a pitiful substitute for love such as he, poor boy, had but just discovered himself capable of giving and receiving.

(*To be continued*).

Wit and Humour.

It will probably turn out that the cup that cheers is a jolly tea.

In what way does money resemble gunpowder? It is awfully hard to hold after it begins to go off.

Utter failures.—Nostrums to cure stammering and stuttering.

When are soldiers like fish in embryo?—When they are all in a row (roe).

Pat wishes to know if the Italian MacO'Rooney he hears spoken of at the grocer's was not born in Ireland.

It was John G. Saxe who wrote:—

Men dying make their wills, but wives
Escape a work so sad;
Why should they make what all their lives
The gentle dames have had?

Proof positive.—Cabby.—"'Ere y'are, sir—hansom?' Echo boy—"Drive on, cabby. 'Es spent all 'is money on the excussion. Tried him just now with a heckar!" (Awkward for the captain, who had not been to Margate and back.)

Holiday-maker—"Come out for a stroll, old chap?" Second ditto—"Tramped to Brighton and back. Can't walk. Sit down and smoke a cigar." First ditto—""Trikked" to Bristol and back. Can't sit!"

It is said to be a fact that a nobleman worked as a labourer on the railroad last fall. He may have been a wheel barrownet.

The rival butcher boys.—First Boy—"Hallo, Yankee Doodle! Why, your master sells nothing but American meat. Yah!" Second Boy—"That's right, old Foot-and-Mouth-Disease. He does, and gets full English price for it, too. Yah!"

THE LATEST GEM.

Farewell, dear girl, farewell, farewell,
I ne'er shall love another;
In peace and comfort may you dwell,
And I'll go home to mother.

To make Randy quail does not take much,
Although in a gladiatorial trim;
And in the arena his tricks as such
That his backers aree'en-a-shamed of

"Now, darling, will you grant me one favour before I go?" "Yes, George, I will," she said, drooping her eye-lashes and getting her lips in shape. "What is the favour I can grant you?" "Only a little song at the piano, love. I am afraid there is a dog outside waiting for me, and I want to scare him away."

A lady was caressing a pretty spaniel, and murmuring, "I do love a nice dog!" "Ah!" sighed a dandy standing near, 'I would I were a dog." "Never mind," retorted the lady, "you'll grow."

Two grammarians wrangling, one contending that it was only proper to say, "My wages is high," while the other noisily insisted that the correct thing was "My wages are high." Finally they stopped a day labourer, and submitted the question to him, "Which do you say, 'Your wages is high,' or 'Your wages are high?' "Oh, off wid your nonsense," he said, resuming his pick, "yer naythur of you right; me wages is low, bad luck to em."

Brown—"What! smoking? I thought you swore off." Fogg—"So I did, and I got along bravely until it came to me that this was leap-year. I hadn't thought of that extra day. A fellow might be able to keep from smoking three hundred and sixty-five days, but the man's got to draw the line somewhere. You can't expect impossibilities from a fellow.

A good story is told of Balzac. One night, while lying awake in bed, he saw a man enter his room cautiously, and attempt to pick the lock of his writing case. The rogue was not a little disconcerted at hearing a loud laugh from the occupant of the room, whom he supposed fast asleep. "Why do you laugh?" asked the thief. "I am laughing, my good fellow," said Balzac, "to think what pains your are taking, and what risk you run, in hopes of finding money by night in a desk where the lawful owner cannot find any by day." The thief at once left.

THE MEAT QUESTION.

Both bread and potatoes are cheap,
An advantage to all and a boon;
Meat was never so high since that nursery leap,
When the red cow jumped over the moon.

No man is an antiquary in his own country.—Scene—An interesting ruin. Fair Visitor (to Oldest Inhabitant)—"Can you tell us which is the sally port?" Oldest Inhabitant—"Noa, leddy; a canna say a knows that, leddy. Happen yow mean Sally Porter, owd John Porter's darter?" Fair Visitor (shocked)—"You don't understand. I mean where the Roundheads broke in and sacked the place." Oldest inhabitant—"Canna say a can tell 'ee, leddy; but it were just here where master broke out an' sacked me. But he were what oi calls more thick head than Round head." (Oldest Inhabitant given up as hopeless).

A fair damsel of the West according to the *Litchfield Democrat*, recently sent this note to her faithful knight:

"Deer Will,—Doant kum to see me eny more for a whial eny way. Fauther has got awfully skeered about burglars, and he sits up every nite till late with a double-barelled shot-gun watching the back yard. He put moren a pound of lead into Brown's Newfoundland dog which was cummin over the fens after a bone light night.

The rose is red, the violet blew,
I wouldn't kum now if I was you."

THE MOTHER-IN-LAW SPEAKS.

Since Noah landed with his ark,
Alas! I've been the patient mark
for witticisms coarse and dark
From pen and tongue,
And since the paragrapher rose
I've been a stranger to repose—
My looks, complexion, gait and clothes
Have all been sung.

No word for all the good I've done—
Of patient toil from sun to sun,
To help two greenies just begun
A new career;
And what a husband! what a bride!
She boils the fish that should be fried,
And looks so bad she runs to hide
When friends appear.

The drinking husband cannot bear
His "wife's old mother sponging there;"
He quite forgets her tender care
When down with fever;
And while she meets his many needs,
His catlses for late hours she reads
In the smell of cloves and cardamon seeds
That don't deceive her.

The paragraphers—heavy wits (?)
Have but two themes for all their hits,
The mule and mother-in law; and it's
An easy matter
To see that, as they are related
Unto the first, they've rather hated
To wound him, and discriminated
Against the latter.

A FEMALE CRUSOE.

THE San Francisco *Call* contains an interesting account of an Indian woman who was accidentally abandoned on San Nicolas Island, off the coast of Southern California, and spent eighteen years alone there before she was rescued. The fact of her existence was discovered by a man who went from the mainland to hunt for otters, and who found footprints deeply sunk in the ground. He was unable to follow up these indications till nearly three years, when one of a party who accompanied him came suddenly upon the object of their search. She was in a small circular enclosure made of brushwood, about 5ft. high and 6ft. in diameter, with a small opening on one side. She was clothed with a garment made of skins of the shag, a species of duck that can neither walk nor fly. This garment reached almost to her ankles when she stood erect. She was sitting cross-legged, skinning seal-blubber with a rude knife made of a piece of hoop iron driven into a piece of wood. There was no covering on her head, except a thick matted mass of hair, of yellowish-brown colour, probably owing to exposure to the sun and the weather; it was short, as if the ends had rotted off. There were some wild dogs on the island, a few of which kept near her, and seemed to regard her as a mistress. She had lived on a plant resembling cabbage, called by Californians *palo santo*, and a root known by the name of *correomite*, also blubber of the various kinds of seals, &c. She had a rude apparatus for catching shellfish, and strong fishing

&c. She had a rude apparatus for catching shellfish, and strong fishing lines made of seal sinews, which seemed to indicate that she fished in the ocean. The expression of her face was pleasing, her features were regular, her complexion much fairer and her form more symmetrical than that of the Indian women on the adjoining mainland. Some suspect that she belonged to a tribe much further north. She could not understand anything said to her in any of the Indian dialects of South California, but she had a wonderful capacity for conversing by signs. She retained all her teeth, but they were worn low, supposed to be due to her chewing tough and hard articles of food. Her age appeared to be about 50 years. She bowed to all who came near her, greeting them with a smile. She freely accompanied her discoverers to their vessel, but her conduct at once convinced them that she retained the virtue of female modesty. She showed singular dexterity in making water-vessels from grass and asphaltum, a substance which is plentiful both on the island and the mainland. She seemed to recognise various appliances of civilisation. She died about seven weeks after reaching the mainland, partly from the effects of a fall, partly from dysentery, brought on by eating fruits and vegetables. Padre Gonzalez, the superior of the mission of Santa Barbara, has sent her dress of shagskins, her basket and implements to Rome, to the Museum of the Propaganda.